

COVER ARTWORK • PLACEHOLDER

Final cover to be supplied. Every page after this one is complete.

The future *is now*

IACTS TechnoCollege CME 2026 — a pre-conference workshop and a two-day CME built for the next generation of cardiothoracic surgeons.

DATES

23 — 25 October 2026

CITY

Hyderabad, India

CONVENED BY

**Department of CTVS, NIMS
Hyderabad**

THE BROCHURE

Contents

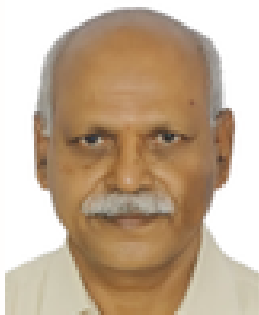
THREE DAYS

One pre-conference workshop day at NIMS, then two scientific days at the Dr. MCR HRD Auditorium.

03	Welcome — Organising Chairman
04	Welcome — Organising Secretary
05	About the CME
06	The three-day flow
07	Day 0 — Surgical Skills & Innovation
08	Day 1 — Inauguration, Keynote & MICS/Robotic
09	Day 1 — Aortic Surgery
10	Day 1 — Pediatric, Digital & the Young Surgeon's Toolkit
11	Day 2 — Transplantation
12	Day 2 — VATS, Robotic & Thoracic
13	Day 2 — MedTech Innovation & Research
14	Day 2 — CVTS 2035 & Closing
15	Industry x Surgeon Technology Labs
16	Registration fees
17	How to register
18	Abstracts
19	Venues & Hyderabad
20	Organising committee
21	Contact

MESSAGE • ORGANISING CHAIRMAN

A mindset of adaptability, innovation and *lifelong learning*

**Dr. G. Ravindra**

ORGANISING CHAIRMAN

DEAR COLLEAGUES,

It gives me immense pleasure to welcome you all to IACTS Technocollege CME 2026, being conducted under the aegis of the Indian Association of Cardiovascular and Thoracic Surgeons.

Technocollege is a timely initiative that brings together young surgeons, postgraduate trainees, experienced practitioners, innovators and technology leaders on a common platform. It is not simply a programme to learn new techniques; it is an opportunity to develop a mindset of adaptability, innovation and lifelong learning. The interactions, demonstrations and exchange of experiences during these three days will, I hope, inspire participants to look beyond the operating room of today and envision the possibilities of tomorrow.

Hyderabad provides a wonderful setting for this meeting. A city that seamlessly combines a rich cultural heritage with a rapidly growing ecosystem of medicine, technology, innovation and entrepreneurship, Hyderabad truly reflects the spirit of this conference. I warmly invite all delegates to experience not only the scientific programme, but also the legendary hospitality, culture, cuisine and warmth of Hyderabad.

I am confident that Technocollege 2026 will be an enriching experience—academically stimulating, professionally inspiring and personally memorable.

I look forward to welcoming each one of you to Hyderabad and to this exciting journey into the future of cardiothoracic surgery.

Dr. G. Ravindra · Organising Chairman

The future is no longer something we are *waiting for*



**Dr. Amaresh Rao
Malempati**

ORGANISING SECRETARY

DEAR COLLEAGUES,

Cardiovascular and thoracic surgery is witnessing an unprecedented transformation. Technologies that were once considered futuristic—minimally invasive and robotic surgery, advanced aortic interventions, mechanical circulatory support, organ transplantation, image-guided procedures and sophisticated thoracic techniques—are rapidly becoming part of contemporary surgical practice. The future is no longer something we are waiting for; it is already happening in our operating rooms.

It is with this conviction that we present IACTS Technocollege CME 2026, under the aegis of the Indian Association of Cardiovascular and Thoracic Surgeons (IACTS). Conceived primarily for postgraduate students and young surgeons in the early stages of their careers, Technocollege is designed to bridge the gap between conventional surgical training and the rapidly evolving technological landscape of our specialty.

We believe that young surgeons should not have to wait until they are established in their careers to encounter the technologies that are transforming our specialty. Technocollege is therefore conceived as a platform to expose, train, question, interact and innovate. More importantly, it brings together young surgeons and pioneers of the field, creating an environment where experiences can be shared, ideas challenged and the learning curve shortened.

Technocollege 2026 is not merely about predicting what cardiac and thoracic surgery will look like tomorrow. It is about experiencing the technology that is already shaping it today.

The future is now. And we invite you to be a part of it.

Dr. Amaresh Rao Malempati • Organising Secretary

ABOUT THE CME

Built for the surgeons who will practise the next decade.

CONCEIVED FOR
Postgraduate students
and young surgeons in
the early stages of their
careers.

A PLATFORM TO

Expose
Train
Question
Interact
Innovate

Conceived primarily for postgraduate students and young surgeons in the early stages of their careers, Technocollege is designed to bridge the gap between conventional surgical training and the rapidly evolving technological landscape of our specialty.

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FOUR SCIENTIFIC DOMAINS

01 Minimally Invasive and Robotic Cardiac Surgery

02 Aortic Surgery

03 Heart-Lung Transplantation

04 Complex Congenital and Thoracic Surgery

INCLUDING VATS AND ROBOTIC THORACIC SURGERY

Convened by Department of CTVS, NIMS Hyderabad • under the aegis of the Indian Association of Cardiovascular-Thoracic Surgeons

HIGHLIGHTS AT A GLANCE

Three days, *one arc*

DAY 0

Pre-Conference Workshop

Surgical skills & innovation — aortic and coronary labs, Technology Olympics, innovation forum and young surgeons' papers.

SIGNATURE FORMATS

Eight recurring formats the programme is built from.

DAY 1

MIS, Robotic & Aortic Surgery

The new operating room — MICS, robotics, contemporary aortic surgery, pediatric and the digital surgeon.

DAY 2

Transplant, Thoracic & Innovation

Heart/lung transplant and MCS, VATS and robotic thoracic, surgeon-led MedTech, research and the future of CVTS.

01

"How I Do It" technical presentations

03

Technology Olympics — competitive skills

05

Young Innovators' pitch & paper sessions

07

Entrepreneurship & personal finance

02

Hands-on surgical laboratories & tech demos

04

Case battles & expert panels

06

AI, digital twins & simulation

08

Industry technology labs

OPERATE WELL • THINK CRITICALLY • INNOVATE RESPONSIBLY

DAY 0 • 23 OCTOBER 2026 • 8:30 AM — 6:00 PM

Surgical Skills & Innovation

VENUE

NIMS • Nizam's Institute
of Medical Sciences,
Punjagutta

FORMAT

Five components, run in
parallel stations.
Capacity-limited.

A highly interactive, capacity-limited pre-conference workshop for postgraduate trainees, fellows and young surgeons — five core components run in parallel stations.

01 Aortic Surgery Laboratory

Hands-on training in contemporary aortic surgical techniques and technologies.

02 Coronary Anastomosis Laboratory

Focused training in the principles and practice of coronary anastomosis.

03 Technology Olympics

A competitive surgical skills challenge across coronary, aortic, robotic and MIS skills.

04 Innovation Display & Young Innovators' Forum

A platform to present innovative ideas, devices, techniques and technology solutions.

05 Young Surgeons' Paper Presentation

A competitive scientific session showcasing high-quality trainee research.

LEARN IT • DO IT • CHALLENGE IT

Every station is built around doing — not watching. Compete, build and present alongside faculty at the cutting edge of CVTS. Workshop places are allocated with registration — select your preference in the registration form.

DAY 1 • 24 OCTOBER 2026 • 8:15 AM — 6:00 PM • DR. MCR HRD AUDITORIUM

Minimally Invasive, Robotic & Aortic

•	Inauguration & Keynote	8:15 — 10:45 AM
8:15	REGISTRATION & BREAKFAST	
9:00	Inauguration • The Future-Ready Cardiothoracic Surgeon Welcome address & introduction to IACTS TechnoCollege	
9:45	Keynote — Scientific Fervour: From Curiosity to Discovery & Innovation TENTATIVE Prof. V. Ramgopal Rao • Group Vice-Chancellor, BITS Pilani	
10:30	Keynote Discussion	
10:45	TEA BREAK	
S1	Minimally Invasive & Robotic Cardiac Surgery	11:00 AM — 1:00 PM
11:00	MICS in 2026: Where Should a Young Surgeon Start? Dr. Nitin Rajput	
11:15	Mini-MVR: Patient Selection, Port Placement & Exposure Dr. Nitin Rajput	
11:30	Mini-AVR: How I Do It Dr. Nagesh	
11:45	Robotic Mitral Surgery: From Simulation to Independent Surgery Dr. Vishal Khante	
12:00	Robotic CABG: What Does the Evidence Really Show? Dr. Gokhale	
12:15	Endoscopic / Robotic Conduit Harvesting Dr. Ritwick Bhuyan	
12:30	Cannulation & Perfusion Strategies for MICS Dr. Nagesh	
12:45	Panel — Is Robotic Cardiac Surgery Ready for Every Centre? Expert Panel	
1:00	LUNCH	

Contemporary *aortic surgery*

S2 Contemporary Aortic Surgery

1:45 — 3:45 PM

- | | |
|------|---|
| 1:45 | Acute Type A Dissection: The First 30 Minutes
Dr. Praveen Varma |
| 2:00 | Aortic Root: Valve-Sparing vs Bentall — How I Decide
Dr. Idhrees |
| 2:15 | Arch Replacement: Cerebral Protection Strategies
Dr. Idhrees |
| 2:30 | Frozen Elephant Trunk: Who Needs It and How I Do It
Dr. Amaresh Rao Malempati |
| 2:45 | Hybrid Arch & TEVAR: Where Does the Surgeon Fit?
Dr. Kaladhar |
| 3:00 | Proximal Anastomotic Devices: Do We Really Need Them?
Dr. Praveen Varma |
| 3:15 | Choosing the Right Graft
Dr. Amaresh Rao Malempati |
| 3:30 | Aortic Case Battle — Two Surgeons, One Difficult Arch Case
Expert Panel |

Case battle decision points — operative strategy · cannulation · cerebral protection · extent of arch replacement · FET vs conventional · hybrid options · management of complications.

Pediatric & the *digital surgeon*

S3 Pediatric & The Digital Surgeon

4:00 – 5:30 PM

- | | |
|------|---|
| 4:00 | Pediatric Valve Repairs: Principles and Pitfalls
Dr. Rajasekhar |
| 4:15 | Changing Face of Redo Surgery in the Pediatric Population
Dr. Rajasekhar |
| 4:30 | AI in Cardiac Surgery: From ChatGPT to the Operating Room
Dr. Amaresh Rao |
| 4:45 | AI for Postoperative Follow-up Care: AID–PaMS
Mr. Khetan Bhokray |
| 5:00 | Digital Twin, VR & Surgical Simulation: Where Are We Going?
University of Hyderabad |
| 5:15 | Interactive Panel — Will AI Replace the Surgeon, or the Surgeon Who Doesn't Use AI?
Expert Panel |

The Young Surgeon's Toolkit

5:30 – 6:00 PM • THREE SHORT TALKS

Personal Finance for Young Surgeons

Building financial independence from day one of a surgical career.

Entrepreneurship for the Young Surgeon

From clinical problem to sustainable enterprise.

Academic & Professional Identity

Research, networking, teaching and responsible social media.

Transplant, Thoracic & Innovation

S4 Heart, Lung & Heart–Lung Transplantation

9:00 – 11:00 AM

9:00	Heart Transplantation in India: Where Are We Today? Dr. Kaladhar
9:15	Recipient Selection: Who Should Get a Transplant? Dr. Bala Subramanyam
9:30	Donor Management & Organ Procurement: The Critical Steps Dr. Bala Subramanyam
9:45	Lung Transplantation: What a Cardiac Surgeon Should Know Dr. Attawar
10:00	Heart–Lung Transplantation: When and How? Dr. Attawar
10:15	LVAD: Bridge, Destination or Bridge-to-Decision? Dr. Gokhale
10:30	ECMO as Bridge to Transplant / Recovery Dr. Gokhale
10:45	Panel — Optimal Management in CAD & Congestive Heart Failure Expert Panel
11:00	TEA BREAK

VATS, robotic & minimally invasive *thoracic*

S5

VATS, Robotic & Minimally Invasive Thoracic Surgery

11:15 AM – 1:15 PM

11:15 VATS in 2026: What Every Young Thoracic Surgeon Must Know

Dr. P. S. S. Gopal

11:30 Robotic Lobectomy: How I Do It

Dr. Aravind

11:45 Robotic Thoracic Surgery: Is It Worth the Investment?

Dr. Bala Subramanyam

12:00 Uniportal VATS: Getting Started

Dr. Manjunath Bale

12:15 Complex Segmentectomy: Beyond the Basics

Dr. Bala Subramanyam

12:30 Mediastinal Surgery Through Minimal Access

Dr. P. S. S. Gopal

12:45 VATS Thymectomy: Tips for the Young Surgeon

Dr. Manjunath Bale

1:00 **Panel — Making Sense of Newer Hardware in Thoracic Surgery**

Expert Panel

1:15 LUNCH & INNOVATION DISPLAY

Innovation, research & *the future*

S6 From Surgical Problem to MedTech Innovation

2:00 — 3:30 PM

2:00 From Surgical Problem to Device: Where Do I Start?

2:10 Design Thinking for Surgeons

2:20 Patent vs Publication: What Should I Do First?

2:30 Prototype to Product: The MedTech Journey

2:40 Regulatory Approval in India: What a Surgeon Needs to Know

2:50 Working with Engineers: How Not to Kill Your Idea

3:00 Young Innovators' Pitch Session

Problem → Idea → Prototype → Impact → What's Next

S7 Research That Changes Practice

3:45 — 4:45 PM

3:45 Clinical Problem to Research Question — and Publishing Your First Good Paper

A practical master class for trainees and young surgeons

4:15 Big Data, Registries & Real-World Evidence in CVTS

Registries, AI-enabled datasets and multicentre collaboration

S8 • 4:45 — 5:30 PM

CVTS 2035 — The Future Operating Room

What will the young surgeon actually need to learn?

PROPOSED PANEL

Cardiac Surgeon
Thoracic Surgeon
Transplant Surgeon
Robotic Surgeon
AI / Data Scientist
Biomedical Engineer
Industry Representative
Young CVTS Surgeon

ON THE TABLE

01 Robotics

03 AR & VR

05 Digital twins

07 3-D printing

09 Remote & telesurgery

11 Tissue engineering

13 Autonomous surgical assistance

02 Artificial intelligence

04 Surgical simulation

06 Image-guided surgery

08 Transcatheter–surgical convergence

10 Personalised surgery

12 Implantable sensors

CLOSING CEREMONY • THE NEXT-GENERATION CARDIOTHORACIC SURGEON

Operate well. Think critically. Research relentlessly. Innovate responsibly.
Embrace technology without losing the art of surgery.

Technology *labs*

HOW IT WORKS

Built around hands-on education rather than sponsored lectures — six immersive labs run alongside the scientific programme.

ALSO

Breakthrough Sessions

01 Robotic Surgery Lab

Console · camera control · instrument manipulation · needle driving · suturing · knot tying · emergency undocking

02 Aortic Technology Lab

Frozen Elephant Trunk · TEVAR · hybrid arch · proximal anastomotic devices · aortic grafts · cerebral protection

03 Coronary Anastomosis Lab

Anastomotic devices · surgical instruments · sutures · beating-heart simulation · microsurgical techniques

04 Thoracic Stapling Lab

Vascular · bronchial · parenchymal and difficult-angle stapling · staple-line reinforcement · troubleshooting

05 ECMO & MCS Lab

ECMO cannulation · circuit configuration · troubleshooting · LVAD technology · emergency MCS scenarios

06 Digital Surgery Lab

3-D surgical planning · VR simulation · digital twins · AI-assisted imaging · surgical video analytics

A distinctive feature of Technocollege, where industry partners and technology innovators will showcase emerging technologies and demonstrate their real-world applications. These sessions are intended to provide participants with an opportunity to see, understand and critically evaluate technologies that may define their practice in the years ahead.

REGISTRATION

Registration *fees*

Charged at the tier active on the date payment is received. All amounts in Indian rupees, inclusive of GST.

CATEGORY	EARLY BIRD TILL 27 SEPT 2026	STANDARD TILL 11 OCT 2026	SPOT REGISTRATION TILL 25 OCT 2026
Resident / Trainee	₹3,000	₹5,000	₹7,000
IACTS Member	₹5,000	₹7,000	₹10,000
Non-Member	₹7,000	₹9,000	₹12,000

EARLY BIRD

01 Jan 2026 — 27 Sept 2026

STANDARD

28 Sept 2026 — 11 Oct 2026

SPOT REGISTRATION

12 Oct 2026 — 25 Oct 2026

INCLUDED WITH EARLY BIRD

Complimentary twin-sharing accommodation at the venue

Early Bird rates apply until 27 Sept 2026. Concessional categories require proof of eligibility.

[REGISTER NOW](#)[FULL FEE DETAILS](#)iactstechnocollegecme2026.com/register

REGISTRATION

How to *register*

PAY TO THIS ACCOUNT

ACCOUNT NAME

**Indian Association of
Cardiovascular-Thoracic
Surgeons**

ACCOUNT NUMBER

1026896747

BANK · IFSC

**Central Bank of India
CBIN0280601**

Mumbai Central Branch, Mumbai
400008



SCAN TO PAY BY UPI

01 Register online

Complete the delegate form on the conference website.

02 Pay the fee

Transfer by NEFT, IMPS or UPI using the account details or the QR code.

03 Attach your proof

Enter the UTR / transaction reference and upload the payment screenshot.
Both are required.

04 Receive confirmation

The secretariat matches your payment and issues your registration ID and QR pass by email.

WHAT YOU WILL BE ASKED FOR

Name, email and mobile · designation and specialization · institution ·
medical registration number · registration category · workshop preference ·
accommodation requirement · UTR and payment screenshot.

REGISTRATION HELPLINE

Virinchi · +91 9014772432

REGISTER ONLINE

iactstechnocollegecme2026.com/register

ABSTRACTS

Abstract *submission*

LAST DATE

**11
October
2026**

FORMAT

Decided by the scientific committee after review — paper or poster. You do not choose.

Abstracts and case reports are invited for the scientific programme. Conference registration is mandatory before you submit.

SUBMISSION RULES

- | | | | |
|----|--|----|---|
| 01 | Conference registration is mandatory for abstract submission. | 02 | The first name in each abstract should be that of the presenting author. |
| 03 | All abstracts/case reports must be submitted in English. | 04 | Abstract in brief includes aim, materials and methods, results, conclusion & clinical significance. |
| 05 | For case reports, introduction, case presentation, discussion & conclusion should be included. | 06 | Abstract in comprehensible English typed in Microsoft Word, Calibri font, size 14, not more than 500 words. |
| 07 | The abstracts should not have been presented or published in any other conference. | 08 | Only the presenting author will be entitled to get a certificate. |
| 09 | Abstracts/case reports submitted will be sent to the scientific committee for review and acceptance. | 10 | Final date for submission is 11 October 2026. |

WHERE TO SUBMIT

Online only, through the conference website.

SUBMIT AN ABSTRACT

iactstechnocollegecme2026.com/abstracts

NOT REGISTERED YET

Register first, then submit from your delegate account.

REGISTER FIRST

contact@iactstechnocollegecme2026.com

WHERE IT HAPPENS

The *venues*

DAY 0 • 23 OCT

NIMS Hyderabad

Nizam's Institute of Medical Sciences

Punjagutta, Hyderabad, Telangana 500082

DAY 1 & 2 • 24–25 OCT

Dr. MCR HRD Institute

Dr. MCR HRD Institute Auditorium

Road No. 25, Jubilee Hills, Hyderabad, Telangana 500033

Both venues are centrally located with easy access from Rajiv Gandhi International Airport and the city centre. Travel notes and recommended stays will be shared with registered delegates.

EXPLORE HYDERABAD

A city of heritage — and of medicine

A rich cultural heritage alongside a fast-growing ecosystem of medicine, technology and innovation — the spirit of this conference.

Golconda Fort

16TH CENTURY

The granite citadel of the Qutb Shahi kings, famous for acoustics that carry a handclap from the gateway to the summit.

Salar Jung Museum

COLLECTION

One of the largest one-man collections in the world — sculpture, manuscripts and textiles from across continents.

Hussain Sagar

HEART OF THE CITY

The lake dividing Hyderabad from Secunderabad, with the monolithic Buddha at its centre.

Birla Mandir

NAUBATH PAHAD

White marble on the hill above Hussain Sagar, with one of the widest views over the city.

Ramoji Film City

DAY TRIP

The world's largest integrated film studio complex, on the eastern edge of the city.

HITEC City

MODERN HYDERABAD

The technology and biotech corridor that made Hyderabad a centre for research and pharma.

LEADERSHIP

Organising *committee*

PATRONS



Dr. Rahul Devraj
CHIEF PATRON



Dr. P. Chandrashekhar
CO-PATRON

ORGANISING COMMITTEE



Dr. G. Ravindra
ORGANISING
CHAIRMAN



Dr. Amaresh Rao Malempati
ORGANISING
SECRETARY



Dr. Tella Rama Krishna Dev
ORGANISING CO-
SECRETARY



Dr. Anita Bhalla
ORGANISING CO-
SECRETARY



Dr. Abhijeet M Dashetwar
TREASURER

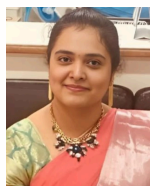
EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE



Dr. B. Kaladhar



Dr. P. S. S. Gopal



Dr. P. Sai Surabhi



Dr. D. Praveen



Dr. K. Sahir Vardhan Reddy



Dr. T. Uday



Dr. A. Bhargavi



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Dr. J. Pramodh Reddy



Dr. Harshita



Dr. M. Tribhuvan

Conference Secretariat • Department of CTVS, NIMS, Hyderabad, Telangana • nimscvts@gmail.com

JOIN US IN HYDERABAD

The future *is now*

Advancing care today, shaping the future of tomorrow.

[REGISTER NOW](#)[SUBMIT AN ABSTRACT](#)[FULL PROGRAMME](#)

CONFERENCE SECRETARIAT

Department of CTVS, NIMS

Hyderabad, Telangana

nimscvts@gmail.com

Dr. Abhijeet M Dashetwar • +91 9866010604

Dr. K. Sahir Vardhan Reddy • +91 9177099793

REGISTRATION HELPLINE

Virinchi • +91 9014772432

WEBSITE

iactstechnocollegecme2026.com

DATES & CITY

23 — 25 October 2026

Hyderabad, India

LEARN IT • DO IT • CHALLENGE IT • INNOVATE IT

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